The 6:15

SATURDAY · OCTOBER 24, 2026 NO. 30

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND FORMAT

Today	Northwestern (AP No. 24, 5-1) hosts Rutgers (2-4), Ryan Field, noon ET; World Series Game 2, Rays at Brewers, Milwaukee, tonight — Brewers lead 1-0.
Next 10 days	Tue-Wed 10/27-28 FOMC (cut odds ~20%-24%, unchanged); Thu 10/29 PCE (Sept.) & Q3 GDP advance, 8:30a ET; Sat 11/1 OPEC+ meets; Tue 11/3 midterms.

Microsoft/Alphabet/Amazon/Meta and Coca-Cola/Boeing earnings dates **not verified this run**.

METRICS · FRIDAY CLOSE, WEEKEND FORMAT

Oil / rates	Brent $116.72 (+3.14%, war-high settle) / WTI $103.27 (+3.82%); spread ~$13.45, widest yet. 2Y 4.69% / 10Y 5.00% / 30Y 5.33%, each +~4bp.
Equities / other	Dow -1.23% to 52,215.16; S&P 500 -0.52% to 7,623.68; Nasdaq Comp. -0.21% to 25,955.34; VIX +2.21% to 19.45. Gold -1.3% to ~$4,008. DXY **not confirmed**. Gas $4.2957/gal, up a third straight day.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Status	Closed to commercial shipping, Day 237 **(single-sourced)**
Transits	4 vessels, Oct. 18 (PortWatch) vs. 85/day baseline — 6 days stale
Strikes, 24h	IRGC claims 2 supertankers mined overnight **(new, uncorroborated)**
Dark tankers	180 of 250 screened, 24h (72.0%) vs. 7-day avg. 100.2 **(may reflect AIS dropout)**
War-risk premium	~32x pre-crisis, dated Oct. 7 — stale
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±8 (Extreme, flat); Escalation Forecast 61±11 (High, -1)

Market odds	Polymarket, unchanged: <1% by 10/31, 6% by 11/30, 12% by 12/31

Methodology: IRGC claims (Iranian state media, uncorroborated), UKMTO (no matching advisory this period), PortWatch (lagged AIS transit count) and straits.live's AIS dark-tanker screen (dropout-sensitive) measure different things over different windows — never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by Tampa Bay.
Knicks	Lost 107-103 at Boston Fri.; now 0-2.
Northwestern	5-1, AP No. 24; hosts Rutgers today, noon ET.

LEAD

OIL AT A WAR-HIGH, STOCKS SINK

A fresh, unverified Iranian mine claim piles onto Thursday's unresolved fabrication dispute

Friday's calm didn't hold. Brent settled at $116.72 a barrel, up 3.14% on the session and the highest close of the seven-month war, per oilprice.com and straits.live, which agree on the figure; WTI settled at $103.27, up 3.82%. The Brent-WTI spread widened to roughly $13.45, the widest this brief has tracked — a sharper divergence than the ~$8.59 spread flagged in issue No. 29 and a sign the crude complex, not just the benchmark everyone quotes, is under stress. That settlement reverses the partial, Yahoo-feed pullback this brief reported Friday morning, when Brent had eased to $109.67 after Thursday's $111.62 print; by the close, the Yahoo and straits.live feeds had converged on a number well above either.

Equities followed oil lower through the full session rather than extending Friday morning's calmer tone. The Dow fell 652.82 points, or 1.23%, to 52,215.16; the S&P 500 slipped 0.52% to 7,623.68; the Nasdaq Composite eased 0.21% to 25,955.34, its second straight

weekly loss. The VIX rose 2.21% to 19.45, putting it on track to close a week above 20 for the first time in some weeks, per Yahoo Finance's wrap. That is a meaningfully worse outcome than the futures-implied open this brief carried Friday morning (S&P futures -0.20%, Nasdaq 100 futures -0.03%) — the session widened the damage rather than holding the morning's partial recovery from Thursday's panic.

Treasury yields moved the other way from Thursday's flight-to-quality bid. The 2-, 10- and 30-year all rose roughly 4 basis points into Friday's official close (to 4.69%, 5.00% and 5.33%), reversing part of Thursday's 13-16bp drop that this brief flagged as inconsistent with a stronger-than-expected jobless-claims print. Read: Thursday's bid for safety was already fading before any new Hormuz claim arrived Friday night — the bond market, unlike equities, did not re-extend the fear trade into the weekend.

Into that setup, a new and still-unverified claim: Iran's IRGC Navy said overnight that two supertankers struck and were disabled by naval mines in what it calls the mined corridor of the strait. No maritime authority, flag state or independent monitor has confirmed it, and UKMTO has issued no matching advisory. It follows directly from Thursday's seven-vessel claim, which President Trump branded fabricated on Truth Social and which also remains uncorroborated; nothing has moved to settle that dispute one way or the other since issue No. 29 went out. Separately, straits.live's AIS dark-tanker screen jumped to 180 of 250 vessels dark in the past 24 hours (72.0%), up sharply from Friday's 103-of-190 reading (54.2%) and well above the 100.2 seven-day average — though the tracker's own methodology note says 180 sits close to what ambient AIS-signal

dropout alone would produce, so this one reading should not yet be read as a change in evasive behavior.

None of this resolves the asymmetry this brief flagged Friday: if Iran's claims are substantially true, the market's Friday pricing — a new oil high, a steeper equity selloff, yields drifting back up — looks like the correct reaction to a real escalation; if they are substantially fabricated, as the president contends, Friday's close priced in another round of claims that may not hold up. One wrinkle cuts against a clean "fear trade" reading either way: gold fell 1.3% to roughly $4,008 even as the rest of the tape moved toward risk-off, the same unreconciled pattern this brief has now flagged twice. Watch: whether UKMTO, a flag state or any insurer corroborates or debunks the new mine claim; whether Saturday's dark-tanker share holds above 70% or reverts toward the 100.2 baseline; whether PortWatch's transit count updates past its six-day-old Oct. 18 reading; and whether Monday's Asia open extends Friday's selloff or reverses it again.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the new mine claim and the dark-tanker jump (Lead), little else moved. PortWatch's transit count is unchanged at 4 vessels on Oct. 18 against an 85-per-day baseline — a reading this brief has now carried, unrevised, for six days, longer than at any point since the methodology note was added. The VLCC war-risk premium this brief tracks at roughly 32x pre-crisis is now more than two weeks stale, dated to an Oct. 7 estimate; it is carried here as background only, not a current price. straits.live's composite indices were little changed: Crisis Pressure holds at 88±8 (Extreme, flat), while the Escalation Forecast eased a point to 61±11 (High), its first decline

after two straight one-point increases. Polymarket's odds on a return to normal transit are unchanged across all three horizons it prices — under 1% by Oct. 31, 6% by Nov. 30, 12% by Dec. 31 — continuing to price a long crisis regardless of either side's claims this week. Diplomatically, nothing has moved: Foreign Minister Araghchi's re-opening offer remains unanswered in anything dated this month, and no OPEC+ delegate has commented on this week's claims ahead of the group's Nov. 1 meeting.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by Tampa Bay in the ALDS.
Knicks	0-2; lost 107-103 at Boston Fri. night (Tatum 36 pts); Towns led New York with 22.
Northwestern	5-1, AP No. 24; hosts Rutgers (2-4) today, noon ET, Ryan Field — result after press time.
World Series	Brewers beat Rays 3-2 in Game 1 Fri. (Misiorowski W, Megill save); lead series 1-0. Game 2 tonight in Milwaukee.

Continuity. Politics, Economics, Business, Technology and Geopolitics (Russia-Ukraine) are cut this weekend issue — nothing broke overnight beyond the market moves in the Lead, and nothing new moved on the others since issue No. 29. Watch for next issue: corroboration or debunking of the new IRGC mine claim; whether the dark-tanker share holds above 70%; PortWatch's transit count past Oct. 18; Monday's market open; Northwestern-Rutgers and World Series Game 2 results.

Unverified figures are marked in red: the IRGC's new two-supertanker mine claim; the ~$13.45 Brent-WTI spread; DXY; gold falling on a nominally risk-off tape, still unreconciled; the 72.0% dark-tanker reading, which straits.live itself flags as consistent with ambient AIS dropout; Big Tech and Coca-Cola/Boeing earnings dates. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.